

**COOPERATIVE AGREEMENT
BETWEEN
MISSOURI VOCATIONAL REHABILITATION
AND
MISSOURI DEPARTMENT OF MENTAL HEALTH
2014**

PURPOSE

This agreement is entered into by Missouri Department of Elementary & Secondary Education, Office of Adult Learning and Rehabilitation Services - Vocational Rehabilitation (MVR) and the Missouri Department of Mental Health (DMH) Divisions' of Developmental Disability and Behavioral Health for the purpose of providing and coordinating quality employment services for Missouri citizens with disabilities who are eligible for Vocational Rehabilitation and Mental Health services.

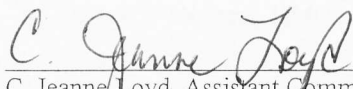
This interagency agreement shall be the mechanism used to address the referral, exchange of information and confidentiality of personal information used for the determination of eligibility of individuals served in common. It will facilitate the coordinated planning of programs and the development of service definitions between MVR and DMH regarding individuals with disabilities who are jointly served by MVR and DMH.

RESPONSIBILITIES

- The mission of MVR, through the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 as amended, is to assist individuals with disabilities in successfully preparing for, obtaining, and retaining employment. MVR provides a variety of services pursuant to this mission.
- MVR is responsible for the determination of an individual's eligibility for services listed under the Rehabilitation Act of 1973 as amended. These services can only be approved by designated MVR staff and coordinated through contracted providers, i.e. Community Rehabilitation Programs (CRP's), medical service providers or those designated in the community in accordance with the act.
- The mission of DMH is the prevention, treatment, and promotion of public understanding for Missourians with developmental disabilities through the Division of Developmental Disabilities (DDD), and mental illness and/or addictions through the Behavioral Health Division (BHD). DMH provides a variety of services pursuant to this mission.
- DDD (or through its contracted services) is responsible for eligibility determination, case management and provision of services for individuals with developmental disabilities. Supports and services are individualized in order to foster self-determination and independence in the community. Employment and career planning is a one of the priorities of service planning.
- BHD is responsible through contracts with community-based agencies for the provision of substance abuse treatment and/or psychiatric rehabilitation services. Services are individualized to meet the needs of the participant and include a wide array of services intended to assist the individual in achieving and maintaining recovery. Recovery is a process of change through which individuals improve their health and wellness, live a self-directed life, and strive to reach their full potential. Employment is recognized as a primary dimension of living a life in recovery.
- MVR and DMH maintain different requirements regarding eligibility, documentation and assignment of services/supports. Nothing within this agreement shall obligate MVR or DMH to abandon or alter their

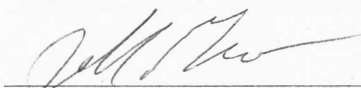
policies in regard to such matters. MVR and DMH will collaborate when planning and providing services at the programmatic and individual level to ensure compliance with respective federal and state funding requirements and regulations.

- MDVR and DMH will work cooperatively to ensure that joint referrals will be made as appropriate. MDVR and DMH will share necessary information regarding program eligibility requirements, description of rules, regulations and policies. MDVR and DMH will share pertinent information regarding the identification, eligibility, accommodation and service provision on a selected basis in accordance with confidentiality guidelines in regard to the protection, use and release of personal information under federal law and state policy in order to provide services to eligible persons with disabilities. MDVR and DMH may exchange information such as names, addresses, Social Security numbers, phone numbers, educational/work history, ICD/diagnosis, services and income information. The purpose of this information sharing is for the timely determination of eligibility for individual(s) served in common, mutual development of employment programs & services and the continuous evaluation of practices.
- Designated agency staff will jointly develop and coordinate procedural guidance for the implementation of specific programs, evidence based practices and services where applicable. Examples of these services include pre-vocational activities to develop soft skills necessary for success in community integration and employment, supported employment (SE) and or individual placement with supports (IPS) to successfully assist individuals in choosing a job, and extended support services to assist individuals in retaining their employment.
- This agreement is effective on the date it is fully executed.
- This agreement may be modified at any time by the written agreement of both parties and may be canceled by either party with thirty (30) days prior notice in writing to the other party.
- The descriptions of laws, legal requirements and duties contained in this document are intended only as a guide between the parties for purposes of this agreement and do not represent any statements of general applicability regarding the principles discussed. The parties retain any legal defenses, as to third parties, to the applicability of any of the referenced laws notwithstanding this agreement. This agreement is not intended to be, and shall not be construed to be a waiver of any such legal defenses.



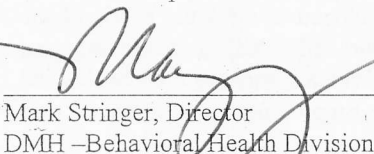
C. Jeanne Loyd, Assistant Commissioner
DESE – Office of Adult Learning and Rehabilitation Services

5/28/14
Date



Jeff Grosvenor, Interim Director
DMH – Developmental Disabilities Division

5/19/14
Date



Mark Stringer, Director
DMH – Behavioral Health Division

5/22/2014
Date